
MEETING MINUTES

The Second Regular Meeting of the Medford School Committee

January 29, 2024

Regular Meeting: 6:00 PM

- I. Roll Call for Attendance of Members and Student Representatives - 7/0 present
Darren Truong and Noah Yurasko Student Representatives
- II. Salute the Flag
- III. Consent Agenda
 - Bills and Payrolls
 - Regular School Committee Minutes, **January 8, 2024**
 - Student Advisory Council Minutes, **November 15, 2023**

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member Branley - 7/0 approved

- IV. Report of Subcommittees
- V. Report of the Superintendent
 - 1. **Superintendent's Updates and Comments** - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Superintendent
 - 2. **Recommendation to Approve** travel to Dartmouth College, Hanover, New Hampshire with Model United Nations - Matthew Brophy, MHS History teacher and Dr. Nicole Chiesa, Director of Humanities
 - Medford High School teacher Jennifer Gates was present and was mentioned for her partnership with Dr. Chiesa and Mr. Brophy.
 - Recognition of students that participated: Ari Atwell, Emma Benaoui, Shayan Chowdhury, Man Chau, Anne Dups, Jack Dodd, Brian DiPlacido, Ciara Godley, Brigitte Inman, Sierra Isbill, Sean Johnson, Muhammed Jammaledine, Evan Russell, Davianna Vega, Kyanna Tra, Kiera Tramble, Jayden Vil, Marija Zasra, Darren Truong, Noah Yurasko

Motion to approve by Member Ruseau, second by Member McLaughlin - 7/0 approved

- 3. **Math Placement Presentation** - presented by Faiza Khan, Director of Mathematics
- 4. **School Update** - Curtis Tufts High School, presented by Laurie Hodgdon, Principal and Brooks Elementary School, presented by Shannon Demos, Principal
 - Curtis Tufts High School
 - Ms. Hodgdon joined by Anthony Seikman, student and Kate Willard, teacher

- To support CTHS call 781-395-7495 or email lhodgdon@medford.k12.ma.us
 - Brooks Elementary
 - Principal Demos joined by Sheila Burke, Assistant Principal
 - Principal wish list to have a substitute bank for coverage and permanent bus monitors.
5. **Excessive Heat Protocol**- Dr. Peter J. Cushing, Assistant Superintendent of Enrichment, Innovation and Operations, and Avery Hines, Director of Health Services
- Updated document requested on or before March 4, 2024 meeting.

Presentations of the Public (not to begin before 7:00 pm)

VII. Continued Business - None

VIII. New Business

2024 - 2 Offered by Member Graham, Member Ruseau, and Mayor Lungo-Koehn

Whereas, Medford High School has been accepted into the Eligibility Phase of the Massachusetts School Building Authority (MSBA) capital project pipeline, and whereas the Medford School Committee seeks to accelerate the time spent in the Eligibility Phase wherever possible, and whereas the Building Committee will require a substantial amount of information that only the Superintendent's team can provide once it is established;

Be it resolved that the School Committee requests the Superintendent to begin working to collect the data necessary to complete key deliverables in the MSBAs eligibility process, including Educational Profile Questionnaire, Chapter 74 Viability, and Maintenance and Capital Planning Questionnaire.

Be it further resolved that an initial draft of the information required to complete these documents is created no later than March 31, 2024.

Date Submitted: January 24, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: January 29, 2024

Motion to approve by Member Graham, second by Member McLaughlin - 7/0 approved

2024 - 3 Offered by Member McLaughlin

Motion for Annual School Committee Agenda

Whereas the Mass Association for School Committees recommends best practice for scheduling
and agenda setting for school committee efficacy,

Whereas communication, planning and transparency is in the best interest of the community,

Whereas Medford Public Schools has an identified strategic plan and clear goals,

Whereas there has historically been an identified pre-schedule to the meetings primarily only known to the Chair and Superintendent,

Be it Resolved, the Medford School Committee, working together through the Chair and Superintendent, create an annual School Committee agenda annually in August with agenda items identified and correlated to relevant goals, to be published by September 5 of the same school year,

Be it Further Resolved ad hoc items to the School Committee agenda be added the Wednesday prior to the upcoming School Committee meeting as required by public notice and emailed to school committee members.

Date Submitted: January 24, 2024

Date Requested to be on the Agenda: January 29, 2024

Motion 2024-3 withdrawn by Member McLaughlin, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 approved to withdraw

Motion to waive reading by Member Graham, second by Member Reinfeld - 7/0 approved

IX. Reports Requested

Substitute Pay Offered by Member Graham and Member Ruseau

- i. Name of the report
 1. Substitute Teacher Supply and Demand Report
- ii. One or more questions the report is attempting to answer (required)
 1. What is the annual need (using School Year 2022-2023 and September - December 2023) for substitutes by level for teachers and paraprofessionals (elementary, middle, high) and by school?
 2. How many substitute slots are filled by level and school for the same time frames?
 3. How does Medford's substitute pay for teachers and paraprofessionals compare to surrounding communities?
 4. How is substitute demand vs availability tracked within central administration?
- iii. Background

1. Substitute teachers play a critical role in maintaining educational continuity and quality when regular teachers are absent; meanwhile, Medford appears to struggle to obtain enough substitutes to cover the need.
 2. Concerns have been raised for a long while regarding the adequacy of compensation for substitute teachers and the potential effect of compensation on the quality and availability of substitutes.
 3. Understanding patterns and reasons for teacher absenteeism is crucial for addressing any underlying issues and ensuring the effective allocation of resources.
- iv. Data elements you are expecting
1. Substitute Teacher Compensation:
 - a) Current compensation rates for substitute teachers across MPS, including any variations by level, education, etc.
 - b) Comparison of these rates with surrounding communities and averages
 - c) Recommendations for any adjustments or changes to the substitute teacher compensation structure
 - d) Identification of which communities used in the comparison have their substitute teachers within a Collective Bargaining Unit.
 2. Substitute Need:
 - a) Data on the rates and patterns of substitute needs by level and school since September 2022
 - b) Identification of maximum and minimum substitute needs by date for each level and school (e.g., our lowest substitute need for the x school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy and our highest for the same school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy)
 - c) Analysis of the reasons for teacher absenteeism, including but not limited to personal illness, professional development, and other leaves
 3. Substitute Availability:
 - a) Data on the rates and patterns of substitute availability by level and school since September 2022
 - b) Identification of maximum and minimum substitute availability by date for each level and school (e.g., our lowest substitute availability for the X school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy and our highest for the same school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy)
 - c) Number of substitutes registered as potential staff by school at the beginning, middle, and end of each school year (since September 2022, along with any other data about peak availability or minimum availability
 - d) Daily unmet need for substitutes by level and school since September 2023
 4. Survey Current and Past Substitutes as well as current teachers and paraprofessionals:

- a) Collect information from current and past substitutes about why substitutes choose this work, the average number of days they work in a school year, whether they are available to take on more days, what limits they have (certain schools, etc), and any other input on the role that is relevant
 - b) Collect information from current teachers and paraprofessionals about substitute availability and the scope of what teachers expect from substitutes
 - 5. Budget Impact:
 - a) Annual budget for substitute coverage for the last 3 fiscal years
 - b) Annual spending for the same three fiscal years per school
 - c) Number of coverage periods provided by teachers/paras during prep sessions since September 2022, along with coverage period rate and cost per school
 - 6. Recommendations and next steps by the administration to address the report findings around substitute supply and demand
- v. Date that the report should be provided: **April 8, 2024**

Motion to approve as amended by Member Reinfeld, second by Member McLaughlin - 7/0 approved

Report as Amended:

Report Request: Substitute Pay

- I. Name of the report (required)
 - A. Substitute Teacher Supply and Demand Report
- II. One or more questions the report is attempting to answer (required)
 - A. What is the annual need (using School Year 2022-2023 and September - December 2023) for substitutes by level for teachers and paraprofessionals (elementary, middle, high) and by school?
 - B. How many substitute slots are filled by level and school for the same time frames?
 - C. How does Medford's substitute pay for teachers and paraprofessionals compare to surrounding communities?
 - D. How is substitute demand vs availability tracked within central administration?
 - E. How do past and present substitute practices impact student services?
- III. Background (optional)
 - A. Substitute teachers play a critical role in maintaining educational continuity and quality when regular teachers are absent; meanwhile, Medford appears to struggle to obtain enough substitutes to cover the need.
 - B. Concerns have been raised for a long while regarding the adequacy of compensation for substitute teachers and the potential effect of compensation on the quality and availability of substitutes.

- C. Understanding patterns and reasons for teacher absenteeism is crucial for addressing any underlying issues and ensuring the effective allocation of resources.
- IV. Data elements you are expecting (optional)
 - A. Substitute Teacher Compensation:
 - 1. Current compensation rates for substitute teachers across MPS, including any variations by level, education, etc.
 - 2. Comparison of these rates with surrounding communities and averages
 - 3. Recommendations for any adjustments or changes to the substitute teacher compensation structure
 - 4. Identification of which communities used in the comparison have their substitute teachers within a Collective Bargaining Unit.
 - B. Substitute Need:
 - 1. Data on the rates and patterns of substitute needs by level and school since September 2022
 - 2. Identification of maximum and minimum substitute needs by date for each level and school (e.g., our lowest substitute need for the x school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy and our highest for the same school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy)
 - 3. Analysis of the reasons for teacher absenteeism, including but not limited to personal illness, professional development, and other leaves
 - C. Substitute Availability:
 - 1. Data on the rates and patterns of substitute availability by level and school since September 2022
 - 2. Identification of maximum and minimum substitute availability by date for each level and school (e.g., our lowest substitute availability for the X school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy and our highest for the same school was # for the date mm/dd/yyyy)
 - 3. Number of substitutes registered as potential staff by school at the beginning, middle, and end of each school year (since September 2022, along with any other data about peak availability or minimum availability
 - 4. Daily unmet need for substitutes by level and school since September 2023
 - D. Survey Current and Past Substitutes as well as current teachers, administrators, and paraprofessionals:
 - 1. Collect information from current and past substitutes about why substitutes choose this work, the average number of days they work in a school year, whether they are available to take on more days, what limits they have (certain schools, etc), and any other input on the role that is relevant

2. Collect information from current teachers and paraprofessionals about substitute availability and the scope of what teachers expect from substitutes
 3. Collect information from building administrators about full- and part-time staff coverage for absence, including the staff roles, responsibilities, and approximate time being diverted from primary duties to provide substitute coverage.
- E. Budget Impact:
1. Annual budget for substitute coverage for the last 3 fiscal years
 2. Annual spending for the same three fiscal years per school
 3. Number of coverage periods provided by teachers/paras during prep sessions since September 2022, along with coverage period rate and cost per school
 4. Number of full-time in-building or cross-school substitutes employed by Medford Public Schools over the last three fiscal years and total spending for those positions. If none, provide data from a comparable time period in which these positions existed.
 5. Number of long-term substitutes (e.g., family or medical leave coverage) hired by Medford Public Schools over the last three fiscal years and total spending for these positions.
- F. Recommendations and next steps by the administration to address the report findings around substitute supply and demand
- V. Date that the report should be provided (required)

April 8, 2024

X. Condolences

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **James “Jack” McDevitt**, who taught business education, government and law over the course of his 37 years of teaching at Medford High School. In 1986, Mr. McDevitt was instrumental in working with the Medford Cooperative Bank to establish a branch of the bank at the high school.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Mariellen Parks**, sister of Larry Parks, custodian at Medford High School.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Yvon J. Richard**, father-in-law of Maureen Richard, Administrative Assistant at the McGlynn School and grandfather of Megan & David Richard, physical education teachers at the Medford Public Schools.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **George Crook**, father of Chef Matthew Crook of the Bistro and loving husband of 54 years to Elaine (Therrien) Crook.

The Members of the Medford School Committee express their sincerest condolences to the family of **Elizabeth “Betsy” Schreuer**, a colleague and librarian with Medford Public Schools, wife of Gary Klein and mother of Rachel, Lydia and Josh Klein all Medford public school graduates or students.

XI. Next Meeting

February 5, 2024 - Alden Memorial Chambers, Medford City Hall in addition to zoom

XII. Adjournment

Motion to adjourn by Member McLaughlin, second by Member Graham - 7/0 approved
Meeting adjourned at 9:04 pm